Business Requirements Document

Project 1 · Employee Onboarding Optimization

Document purpose. Describe the business problem, desired outcomes, scope, stakeholders and business-level requirements for improving the employee onboarding experience.

1. Executive summary

The onboarding process involves handoffs between HR, IT and new employees. When tasks depend on repeated emails, unclear ownership or manual follow-up, employees may arrive without the access, equipment or information they need. This initiative aims to make onboarding more predictable by clarifying responsibilities, standardizing requirements and identifying opportunities to automate routine work.

Project evidence supplied The project summary states that 25+ user stories were documented in JIRA, BRD/FRD documents were prepared, sprint planning accelerated by 30%, six automation opportunities were identified, and manual touchpoints were reduced by approximately 40%. These are treated as reported outcomes, not independently verified measurements.

2. Business problem and opportunity

- Onboarding activities cross HR, IT and employee teams, creating multiple handoffs.
- Requirements and acceptance criteria may be interpreted differently by stakeholders if they are not documented consistently.
- Email-based coordination can create duplicate requests, missed follow-ups and limited visibility into task status.
- A more standardized workflow can improve new-hire readiness, accountability and the employee experience.

3. Business objectives and success measures

Objective	Measure / target	How to validate
Reduce manual coordination	Approximately 40% fewer manual touchpoints (reported project outcome)	Compare a defined baseline with the post-change workflow; agree what counts as a touchpoint.
Improve delivery planning	30% faster sprint planning (reported project outcome)	Compare planning duration across comparable sprints before and after the changes.
Improve requirement clarity	25+ user stories with acceptance criteria	JIRA review for completeness, stakeholder approval and testability.
Increase new-hire readiness	Fewer onboarding tasks incomplete by the employee start date	Track readiness checklist completion and exceptions.
Reduce redundant communication	Fewer duplicate or avoidable onboarding emails	Review email/workflow volume and sample cases before and after implementation.

4. Scope

In scope

- Map the current onboarding journey and handoffs between HR, IT and employees.
- Document business requirements, user stories and acceptance criteria in JIRA.
- Identify workflow gaps, duplicated emails and automation opportunities.

- Define onboarding task ownership, status visibility and service-level expectations (SLAs).
- Document requirements for access provisioning and related IT coordination, including Active Directory where applicable.

Out of scope unless separately approved

- Replacing the organization's HRIS, identity platform or email platform.
- Redesigning payroll, benefits, recruitment or offboarding processes beyond required onboarding handoffs.
- Implementing integrations or automation not confirmed during technical discovery.
- Changing enterprise security policies or access approval authority.

5. Stakeholders and responsibilities

Stakeholder	Primary responsibility
HR / People Operations	Own employee data readiness, onboarding communications and HR task completion.
IT / Service Desk	Own device, account and access-related tasks; confirm technical feasibility and support model.
Hiring manager	Confirm role-specific needs, team readiness and first-day expectations.
New employee	Complete assigned forms and required onboarding actions; report blockers.
Business analyst / project team	Facilitate workshops, map processes, maintain requirements and coordinate sign-off.
Security / identity administrator (as needed)	Validate access controls, approvals and Active Directory-related requirements.

6. Business requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority
BR-01	The onboarding process shall define clear ownership for each HR, IT and employee task.	Must
BR-02	The process shall provide a consistent view of task status, due dates and outstanding blockers.	Must
BR-03	The process shall reduce avoidable duplicate emails and repeated manual follow-ups.	Must
BR-04	The process shall support timely preparation of required accounts, access and equipment before the start date, subject to approvals.	Must
BR-05	The process shall define and communicate SLAs for key onboarding activities.	Must
BR-06	The process shall retain an auditable record of task completion and relevant approvals.	Should
BR-07	The process shall accommodate role- or department-specific onboarding tasks where required.	Should
BR-08	The process shall support reporting on completion, delays, exceptions and readiness.	Should

7. High-level business process

1. HR confirms the new-hire record, role, department, manager and start date.
2. The onboarding workflow creates the standard task set and routes tasks to the appropriate owners.
3. IT reviews approved access and equipment needs, provisions items according to policy, and records status.
4. The hiring manager confirms role-specific requirements and team readiness.
5. The employee receives consolidated instructions and completes assigned pre-boarding actions.
6. The workflow highlights overdue tasks or blockers to the responsible owner for follow-up.
7. HR or the designated owner verifies readiness and closes the onboarding checklist.

8. Assumptions, dependencies and constraints

- The organization has an existing source of new-hire information; the specific system of record must be confirmed.
- Existing tools may include JIRA, email, Active Directory and a diagramming tool such as MS Visio or Lucidchart, as listed in the project summary.
- Access provisioning remains subject to security policy, least-privilege principles and required approvals.
- The exact SLA values, notification rules, data retention period and integration capabilities require stakeholder confirmation.
- The reported 30% and approximately 40% improvements should be supported by an agreed baseline and measurement method.

9. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Potential impact	Mitigation
Unclear ownership	Tasks remain incomplete or are repeatedly reassigned.	Name a responsible role and escalation path for each task.
Incomplete or late source data	Accounts or equipment are not ready by day one.	Define required fields, validation and exception handling.
Over-automation	Incorrect access or communications are triggered.	Use approvals, test cases, audit logs and controlled rollout.
Stakeholder adoption gaps	Teams continue using old email-based processes.	Provide short role-based guidance and agree a transition plan.
Unmeasured baseline	Benefits cannot be credibly demonstrated.	Capture baseline definitions and reporting before launch.

10. Acceptance and sign-off

The BRD is ready for business sign-off when the scope, business requirements, ownership model, success measures and open decisions have been reviewed by HR, IT and the business owner.

Role	Name	Decision / date
Business owner	To be completed	To be completed
HR representative	To be completed	To be completed
IT representative	To be completed	To be completed

Appendix: tools referenced in the project summary

JIRA · BRD/FRD · Swimlane diagrams · MS Visio/Lucidchart · Active Directory · Email workflow mapping